

Marketing Dashboard Blueprint

A method for building measurement that gets used, not just built — designed from the user journey backwards, not from whatever Google Analytics happens to show by default.

How to use this: follow the order below. Most dashboards fail because step one gets skipped — teams open the analytics tool first and build around what's already there, instead of designing measurement to match the journey.

1. Map the journey before opening any analytics tool

- ☐ Draw the actual path a customer takes, channel by channel, before deciding what to measure
- ☐ Match each step in that path to a stage in your buying journey — not a generic funnel template
- ☐ Only once this map exists should analytics segments get built around it
- ☐ This single step is the one most often skipped, and it's the one that determines whether the whole dashboard actually gets used

2. Fix the naming convention first

- ☐ Campaign, medium, source and content each need a fixed, written taxonomy before a single ad goes live
- ☐ Auto-tagged channels (paid search, paid social) still need consistent campaign naming layered on top
- ☐ One inconsistent tag breaks a whole channel's reporting — write the convention down and share it, don't rely on memory
- ☐ Decide the naming convention once, before launch — retrofitting it onto live campaigns loses the earliest, often most useful data

3. Structure sections around decisions, not tools

- ☐ Each dashboard section should answer one specific question someone needs to act on
- ☐ A summary/benchmark view first, then one section per channel — not one dashboard per tool
- ☐ If a widget doesn't change what anyone does next, it doesn't belong on the dashboard
- ☐ A dashboard that tries to serve every audience at once usually ends up genuinely useful to none of them

4. Put a target or benchmark on everything that matters

- ☐ A number with no benchmark next to it doesn't tell anyone whether it's good
- ☐ Use last period's real, actual figures as the starting benchmark — not an invented target
- ☐ State the assumption behind any forecast explicitly, including what would make it wrong
- ☐ Revisit the benchmark itself periodically — a target set a year ago on different channel mix and spend levels stops being a fair comparison

Why this matters: a dashboard built from the tool outward always ends up organised around what's easy to pull, not what's useful to act on. Building it from the journey inward is slower to set up once, and faster to actually use every week after.



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I design measurement systems and dashboards for a living. If yours was built around the tool rather than the journey, it's worth a proper look.

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